

mtg-liquidity-signal: the Current Liquidity index

Snapshot 2026-08-01. By Cameraderie Cards. Informational only, not financial advice.

Every existing model in this toolkit tells you *direction*: will a card rise (buy), has it peaked (sell), is it about to be reprinted (brace). None of them tells you whether you can actually **exit**. A perfect sell call is worthless on a card that takes months to move and only at a deep discount. This model fills that gap. It assigns every Magic: The Gathering card a **Current Liquidity** score from 0 to 100: how easily an owner could turn it into cash right now.

What goes into the score

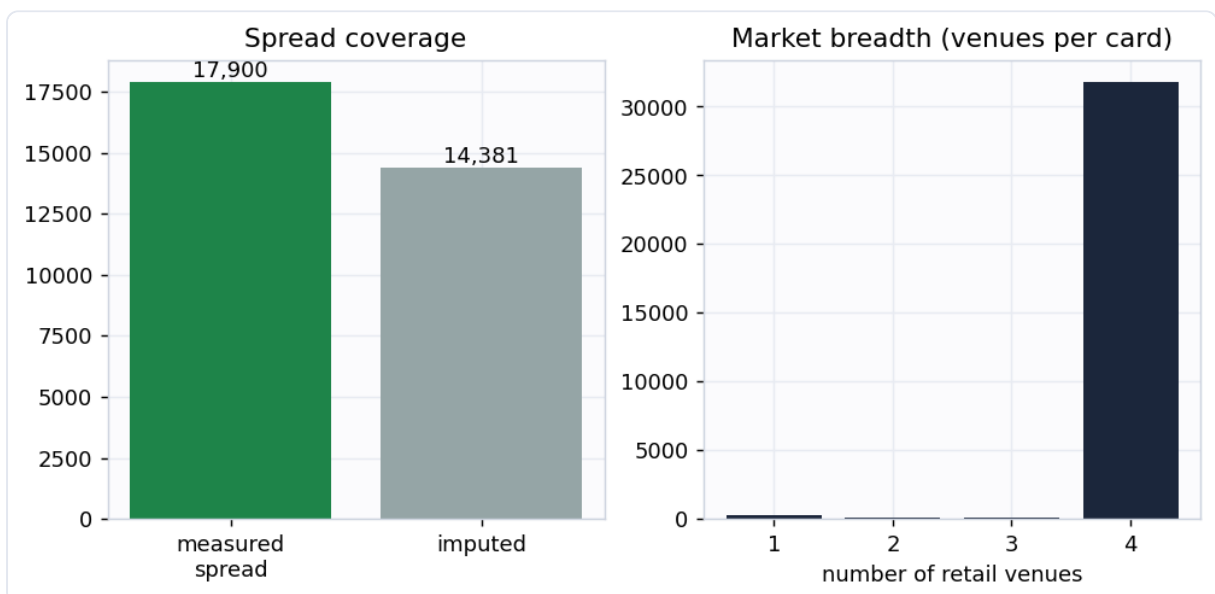
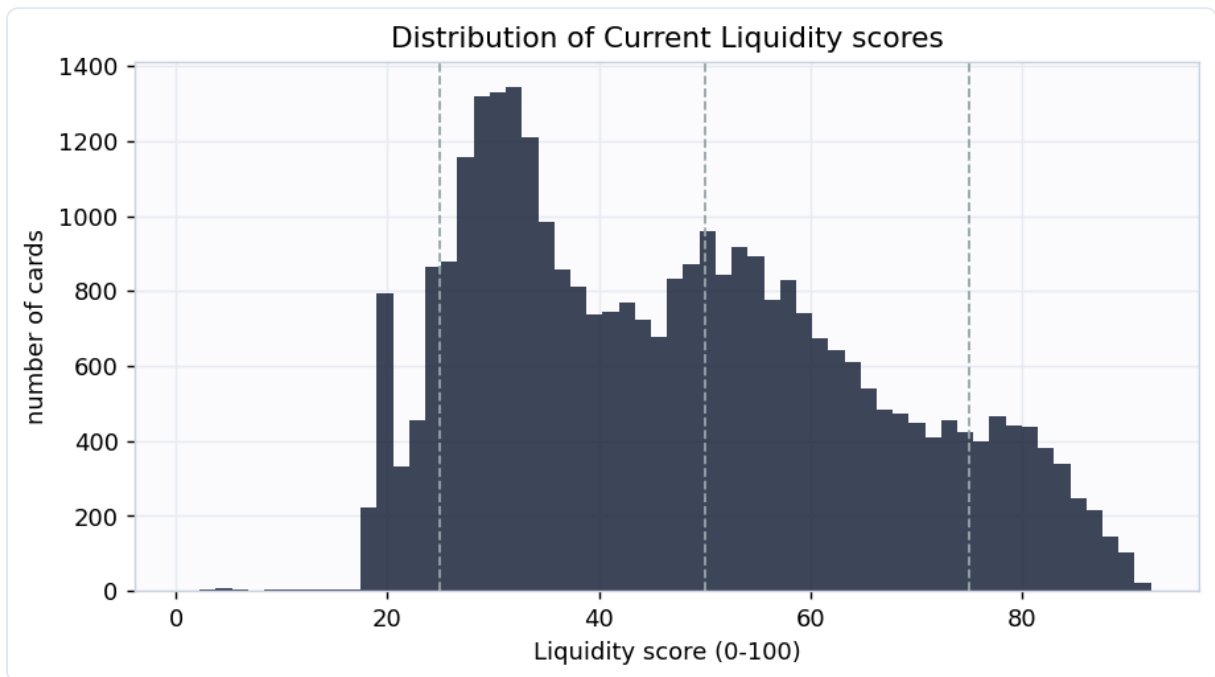
Liquidity is built from four measurable proxies, each normalized to a percentile and blended (weights {'spread': 0.4, 'depth': 0.25, 'activity': 0.2, 'demand': 0.15}):

Component	What it measures	Source
Spread	bid-ask cost to round-trip, CardKingdom buylist vs retail on the same printing	multi-venue price feed
Depth	how many venues list the card, whether a dealer will buy it, cross-venue price agreement	multi-venue price feed
Activity	how often the quoted price actually moves over 120 days (a flat price means nothing is trading)	16-year daily history
Demand	Commander-format popularity (EDHREC)	EDHREC

A card scores high only when it is cheap to exit, sold in many places, actively repricing, and wanted. The weights lean on the spread because that is the cost an owner actually pays to sell.

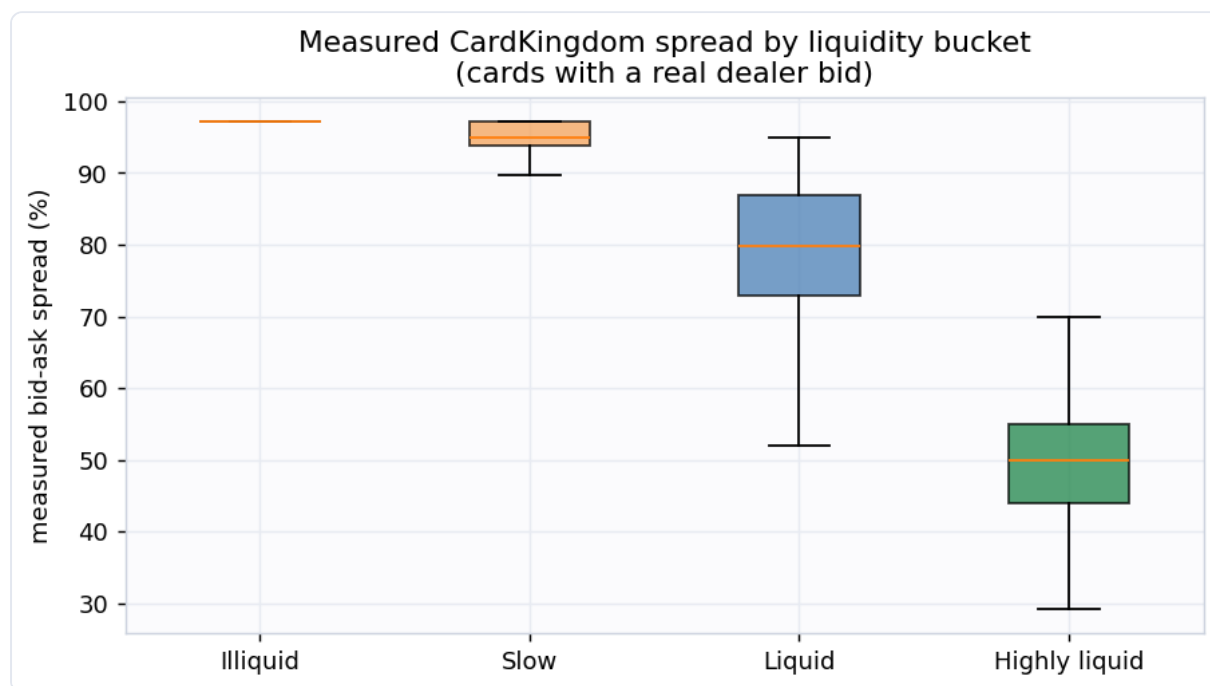
Coverage

Scored **32,281 cards** at this snapshot. **17,900** of them have a real dealer bid (CardKingdom buylist), so their spread is **measured**, not estimated; the median measured spread is **87.0%**. Cards without a dealer bid are flagged `is_imputed` and scored from depth, activity, and demand only.



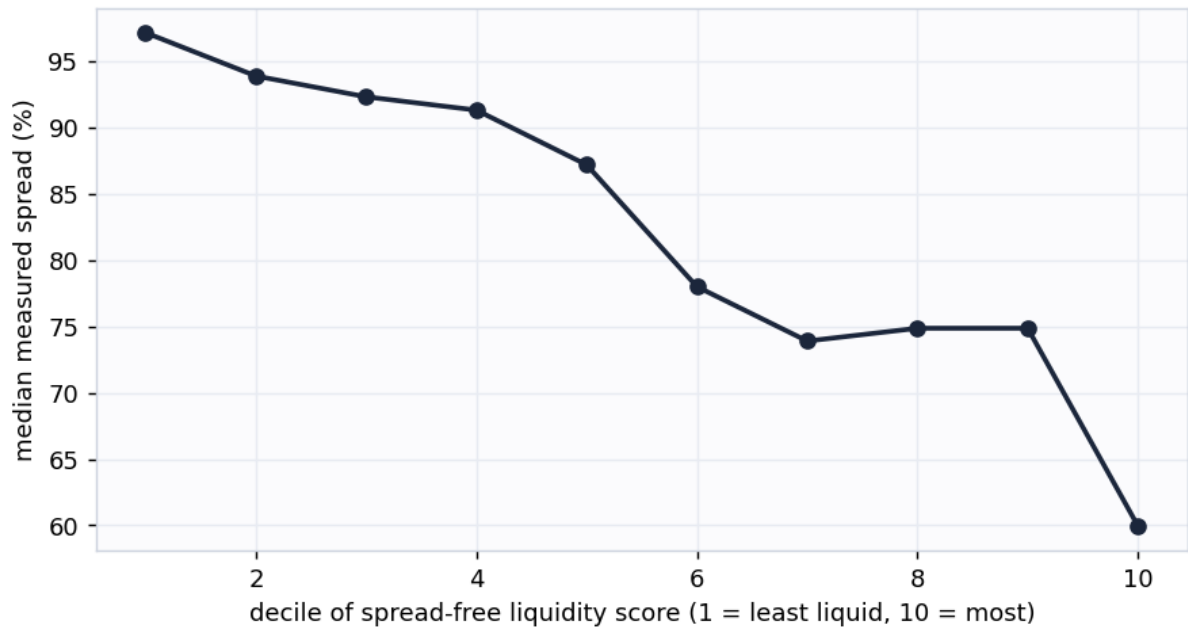
Does the score mean anything? Two honest checks

1. Measured spread lines up with the buckets. Cards the index calls illiquid really do cost more to round-trip. Because the spread is one input to the score, this is partly a consistency check rather than a clean test.



2. Independent proxies predict the spread (the real test). If we rank cards using *only* depth, activity, and demand and deliberately **exclude the spread**, the measured spread still falls steadily as that spread-free score rises (rank correlation **0.475**). The proxies that never saw the spread agree with the spread. That is genuine corroboration, not circular reasoning.

Independent proxies predict the measured spread (spread excluded from this ranking)



Example cards

Example cards (snapshot 2026-08-01)

	Cavern of Souls score 92 spread 35%	Necropotence score 92 spread 33%	Toxic Deluge score 92 spread 37%	Mizzix's Mastery score 91 spread 39%	Blood Crypt score 91 spread 39%
Most liquid	Land As Cavern of Souls enters the battlefield, choose a creature type. • Add •. • Add one mana of any color. Spend this mana only to cast a creature spell of the chosen type, and that spell can't be countered.	Enchantment Skip your draw step. Whenever you discard a card, exile that card from your graveyard. Pay 1 life: Exile the top card of your library face down. Put that card into your hand at the beginning of your next end step.	Sorcery As an additional cost to cast this spell, pay X life. All creatures get -X/-X until end of turn. "Zemo insults me by talking me with swabbings such as you. Even together, you pose no challenge." —Radioactive Man, Dr. Chen Lu	Sorcery Exile target card that's an instant or sorcery from your graveyard. For each card exiled this way, copy it, and you may cast the copy without paying its mana cost. Exile Mizzix's Mastery. Overload ••••• (You may cast this spell for its overload cost. If you do, change "target" in its text to "each.")	Land — Swamp Mountain (••••• Add • or ••) As this land enters, you may pay 2 life. If you don't, it enters tapped. The hellish mines of Ronomus fueled the war efforts of the Roman Star Empire, until the Romans found a champion.
Least liquid (> \$5)	Planeswalker — Bolas Each opponent loses 3 life unless that player sacrifices a nontap permanent or discards a card. • Destroy target creature. Draw a card. Nicol Bolas, the Deceiver deals 7 damage to each opponent. You draw seven cards.	Creature — Tiger Forestwalk. (If defending player has a forest in play, Zodiac Tiger can't be blocked.) "... Three kings no more — Chandra, Ginteng, Asha. The felt and joints must now be filled again. ..." Illus. Ai Dezhong	Sorcery Choose any one creature. This turn, all creatures able to block it do so. Inspired by their opponents' widening scars, even into generally more inured to reality, lead their troops into battle — often to disastrous defeat. Illus. Gao Yan	Legendary Artifact — Equipment Equipped creature has first strike and gets +1/+0 for each instant and sorcery card in your graveyard. Whenever equipped creature deals combat damage to a player, you may cast an instant or sorcery spell from your hand with mana value less than or equal to that damage without paying its mana cost. Equip •	Legendary Creature — Phyrexian Praetor Haste At the beginning of your upkeep, exile the top card of your library. You may play it this turn. At the beginning of each opponent's upkeep the next time they would draw a card this turn, instead they exile the top card of their library. They may play it this turn.

The most liquid cards are heavily played eternal and Commander staples that sell in minutes at a known price. The least liquid expensive cards are thin-market oddities: no dealer will quote a buy price, and they list in only one or two places.

Buckets

Bucket	Score	Cards	Median measured spread
Highly liquid	75-100	3,312	49.9%
Liquid	50-75	10,687	79.9%
Slow	25-50	15,614	94.9%
Illiquid	0-25	2,668	97.1%

How this plugs into the other signals

Liquidity is a multiplier on every other call. It converts "should I sell" into "can I sell, how fast, at what cost," and it filters out illiquid buy candidates the spike model would otherwise flag. In the toolkit's risk-adjusted value equation, the expected value of a position is discounted by its spread and expected time-to-sale to get a **net realizable** value.

Honest limitations

- This is **version 1: a composite proxy index, not a supervised forecast**. It does not carry a held-out AUC because there is no public ground-truth label for "days to sale."
- There is **no true traded-volume or listing-count data yet**. Spread, price staleness, and venue breadth are stand-ins for depth and velocity. The roadmap adds TCGplayer listing counts and sales velocity (the printing table already carries the join key), which will replace the proxies with measured depth.
- Buylist coverage is CardKingdom-only and United States centric. Cards without a CardKingdom bid have an imputed spread and should be read with that caveat.
- Informational only, not financial advice.

Generated by `scripts/build_report.py` from `data/processed/liquidity_features.parquet`.